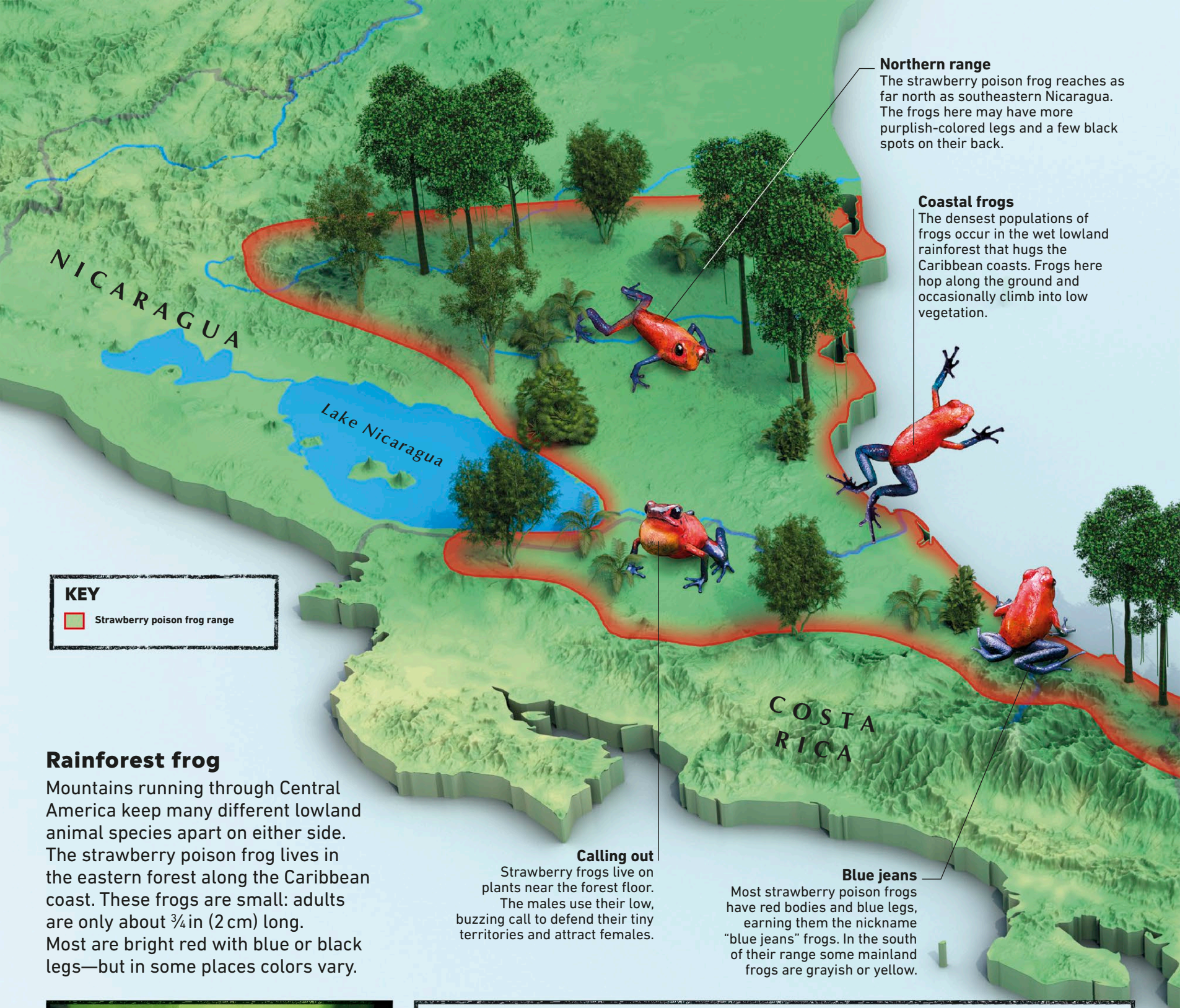




Northern range

The strawberry poison frog reaches as far north as southeastern Nicaragua. The frogs here may have more purplish-colored legs and a few black spots on their back.

Coastal frogs

The densest populations of frogs occur in the wet lowland rainforest that hugs the Caribbean coasts. Frogs here hop along the ground and occasionally climb into low vegetation.

KEY

 Strawberry poison frog range

Rainforest frog

Mountains running through Central America keep many different lowland animal species apart on either side. The strawberry poison frog lives in the eastern forest along the Caribbean coast. These frogs are small: adults are only about $\frac{3}{4}$ in (2 cm) long. Most are bright red with blue or black legs—but in some places colors vary.

Calling out

Strawberry frogs live on plants near the forest floor. The males use their low, buzzing call to defend their tiny territories and attract females.

Blue jeans

Most strawberry poison frogs have red bodies and blue legs, earning them the nickname “blue jeans” frogs. In the south of their range some mainland frogs are grayish or yellow.



Plant pool

Strawberry poison frogs are careful parents. They lay their eggs on forest leaves. When they hatch, the tadpoles are carried on the mother's back to a pool of water in a bromeliad plant, where they turn into frogs.

Color varieties

The strawberry poison frog comes in more than 100 different colored varieties called morphs. Most of these varieties occur on tiny islands off the Central American coast, where frogs are cut off from those on the mainland. They have different colors because their populations have been separated for thousands of years and have evolved to look different.



Color morphs of the strawberry poison frog